

Varunprasaath R. Selvaraju, Ph.D.

(+1) 678-207-9914 | varunprasaath@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/varunprasaath-rs](https://www.linkedin.com/in/varunprasaath-rs)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

PhD chemist/materials scientist with 6+ years in physicochemical characterization, method documentation, instrument troubleshooting, and analytical structure-property studies. Experienced with UV-Vis/FT-IR, GPC/SEC, NMR, GC-MS/LC-MS exposure, TGA/DSC, DOE/SPC, and technical reporting that support material-quality decisions and assay/method transfer readiness.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Physicochemical Characterization

LC-MS / SEC / UV-Vis Exposure

Method Development Mindset

Protein-Reagent Bridge

Validation Documentation

Instrument Troubleshooting

Technical Reports

Cross-Functional Communication

WORK EXPERIENCE

University of Colorado Boulder

July 2025 - Present

Postdoctoral Researcher

- Lead DOE-guided process-development and analytical readout design for bio-based polymer systems, defining reproducibility criteria, process windows, and SOP-ready specifications.
- Translate FT-IR, thermal-analysis, spectroscopy, and process data into technical recommendations and documented methods for repeatable execution.

University of Colorado Boulder

July 2021 - July 2025

Graduate Researcher

- Designed, purified, and characterized 15+ organic material variants using UV-Vis-NIR, FT-IR, cyclic voltammetry, spectroelectrochemistry, NMR, GPC/SEC, TGA, DSC, and MS-informed analysis.
- Built structured datasets and written summaries connecting chemical structure, purity, stability, and analytical signals to material performance and troubleshooting decisions.

Georgia Institute of Technology

Aug 2019 - July 2021

Graduate Researcher

- Co-led thin-film coating process development, linking CVD/surface-preparation variables to morphology, interface quality, optical performance, and reproducible process controls.

ETH Zurich

May 2017 - July 2017

Research Assistant

- Optimized polymer thin-film deposition using DOE strategies and in-situ QCM-D process monitoring to quantify growth kinetics and coating reproducibility.

University of Colorado Boulder

2021 - 2025

Laboratory Operations Manager

- Managed characterization/process-development lab operations for a 15-member group; implemented equipment tracking, calibration routines, SOPs, and safety protocols that improved instrument uptime by 30% and strengthened data integrity.

Georgia Tech

2019-2021

Teaching Assistant, Organic Chemistry I & Lab

- Mentored 120+ undergraduates; developed supplemental materials improving exam performance by 15%.

KEY PROJECTS

Physicochemical Method Development Bridge Target Role

Connects material-quality questions to LC-MS/SEC/UV-Vis/FT-IR-style analytical readouts, documentation, validation mindset, and troubleshooting.

LC-MS exposure, GPC/SEC, UV-Vis, FT-IR, method documentation

Analytical Stability and Degradation Study Chemistry of Materials 2025

Mapped degradation and performance failure modes across functional material variants using orthogonal analytical characterization.

UV-Vis-NIR, FT-IR, CV, TGA/DSC, NMR, GPC, MS-informed analysis

Lab Operations and Instrument Reliability Leadership

Managed SOPs, calibration, safety, training, and equipment systems supporting dependable multi-user characterization workflows.

Instrument uptime, SOPs, troubleshooting, data integrity

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Chemistry - University of Colorado Boulder

2025

Dissertation: Modular Design and Electrochemical Properties of Xanthene-Based Electrochromic Materials

Advisor: Prof. Seth Marder

(Transferred from Georgia Institute of Technology)

B.S. (Research), Major: Chemistry; Minor: Materials Science - Indian Institute of Science (IISc)

2019

INSPIRE Scholarship for Higher Education (Top 1% nationally)

CERTIFICATIONS

Statistical Process Control (SPC) - Coursera, 2026

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Analytical Characterization: UV-Vis-NIR, FT-IR, NMR, GPC/SEC, GC-MS/LC-MS exposure, QCM-D, TGA, DSC, cyclic voltammetry, spectroelectrochemistry

Method Development & Validation Mindset: Reproducibility studies, assay/method documentation, SOPs, data summaries, troubleshooting, transfer readiness, validation/qualification language

Materials & Chemistry: Organic/materials chemistry, polymers, protein-reagent/bioconjugation concepts to be bridged, thin films, structure-property analysis

Data & Communication: DOE, SPC, Excel, Python/basic, JMP/basic, technical reports, publications, cross-functional presentations, lab notebooks

JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

1. Ramasamy Selvaraju, V.; Venta, R.; Rajapaksha, I.; Zhang, J.; Barlow, S.; Salman, S.; Scott, C.; Marder, S. "Narrow-Band Electrochromism of a Ferrocene-Substituted Rhodamine B." *Chemistry of Materials*, 2025, 37, 5558-5568.
2. Mandal, J.; Ramasamy Selvaraju, V.; Yan, W.; Divandari, M.; Spencer, N. D.; Dubner, M. "In Situ Monitoring of SI-ATRP Throughout Multiple Reinitiations Under Flow by Means of a Quartz Crystal Microbalance." *RSC Advances*, 2018, 8, 20048-20055.
3. Ramasamy Selvaraju, V.; Venta, R.; Rajapaksha, I.; Zhang, J.; Barlow, S.; Salman, S.; Scott, C.; Marder, S. "Beyond Rhodamine B: Investigating Alternative Xanthene Cores for Modular Electrochromic Systems." (Manuscript under preparation).

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Modular Design and Electrochemical Properties of Xanthene-Based Electrochromic Materials, ACS Fall National Meeting, Denver, CO, August 2024.

Electrochemical and Spectroscopic Properties of Substituted Rhodamine Derivatives, Gerischer-Lewerenz Electrochemistry Symposium, Fort Collins, CO, August 2024.

Decoupling Redox and Color for High-Contrast Electrochromics, Excited State Processes Conference, Santa Fe, NM, June 2023.

Electrochromism: Decoupling Color and Redox in Rhodamine-Based Systems, Rocky Mountain Solid State Chemistry Workshop, Boulder, CO, January 2023.

HONORS & AWARDS

Plastic Sustainability Innovation in Material Award | INSPIRE Scholarship (Top 1%, India, 2015) | 97.12 Percentile - IIT JEE Mains (2015) | All India Rank 144 - NEST (2014)